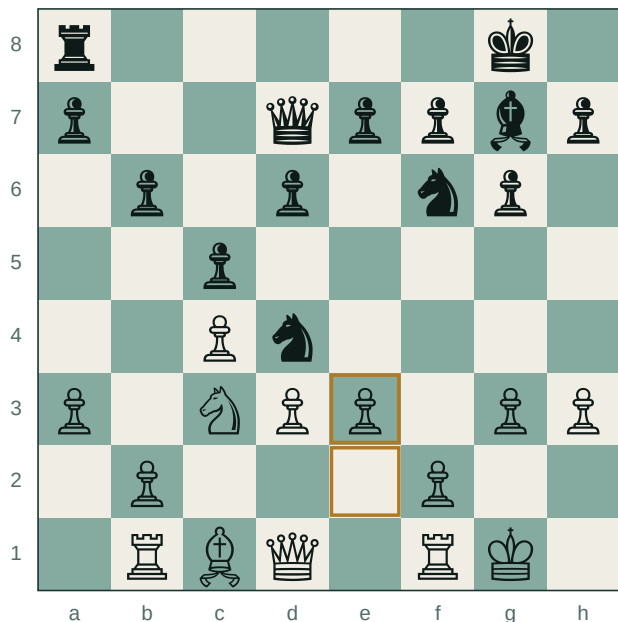


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 14

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 14.e3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

14...Qxh3 15. exd4 Ng4 16. Qxg4 Qxg4

14...Qxh3 The queen captures the pawn on h3. Recorded reply: **15.exd4**.

15...Ng4 The knight moves from f6 to g4. Recorded reply: **16.Qxg4**.

16...Qxg4 The queen captures the queen on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.